

SHEKHAR SUMAN

He got himself a new body at 47 and a brand new career to go with it. "There came a point when I grew bored with myself as I looked into the mirror," says the man. Then in December 2006, he decided to turn over a new leaf. He weighed 76 kg when he hit the gym. But within three months, the scales pointed to 65. The current look is more about a lean frame rather than too much bulk. "Your muscles must be ripped and well-defined," says the man. In the beginning, he used to train for seven days a week. He has brought it down to four to five days now. He also swims once a week and is a great fan of power yoga. How about his diet? Initially low on carb (in fact, no carb after 7 p.m.), now he has included salads, soups and brown bread in his diet. And his dreams? "That I may still be wearing a pair of Versace jeans when I'm 60 and have a Stallone-like body at 70."

spent on cosmetics, apparel and mobile phone bills. This does not surprise Sahil Shroff, 28, a Mumbai-based model who runs his own clothing store. "There's a new premium on the body now," he says. A fitness freak, he is now concentrating on developing his abs. "I'm in good shape and I am proud of it. Abs make everything in modelling," he says.

In movies, heartthrobs—Salman Khan, Hrithik Roshan, John Abraham—are seen shirtless, with rippling pecs and lats; on fashion runways male models in skin-tight tanks and jackets, unbuttoned to flaunt washboard bellies, pace before cheering crowds. "The male body is being offered up for scrutiny," adds Kakar. And men are scared of losing their hair, their muscle mass, their youth. Cosmetic surgeons, too, feel there's a greater tendency to show off muscles among men these days. When Amit Sandhu, 25, moved to Delhi from Panipat, Haryana, "to become a model", he faced a tough time. From "healthy", he became "bulky". "Sudd-

"Men believe they have to look presentable to make the cut in today's world."

DR NARENDRA PANDYA, MUMBAI

only I was no longer proud of my body."

The spectrum of new cosmetic procedures available to men reflects the trend. If the earlier cosmetic procedures sported functional names and provided useful services, new methods now are modelled on male anxieties and have fancy feel-good names. "Muscle sculpting" and "body contouring" are the buzzwords now. Go for "abdominal etching", if you want a washboard-flat stomach. "Fat transfer" will augment various parts of your body—biceps, calf muscles, hands—by surgically rounding them out with your own fat. A "facial rejuvenation" will build volume, filling, lifting, repositioning, and reducing inelastic facial tissue. With "body contouring", you can remove unwanted skinfolds surgically. "The male body image is going beyond a

Best Kept Secrets of the Stars

Most celebrities deny they've had work done, but their doctors know the truth...

BOTOX: A non-surgical injection used to temporarily paralyse muscles that cause wrinkles, primarily around the eyes and forehead. Each injection lasts three to four months.

FILLERS: Soft-tissue fillers, such as Restalyne and collagen, are injected into the face to fill out a depressed area, such as the folds between the nose and lips.

VOLUMETRIC FACELIFT: Fat is taken from the abdomen and injected into the face, creating high cheekbones. For some, it is permanent, but others need to repeat it in five years.

ONE STITCH FACELIFT: A lunchtime procedure done under local anaesthesia. Loose skin is tightened and stitched once on each side of the face under the hairline. No bruising; effect can make patients look five years younger.

POWER BLEACHING: Doctors apply whitening gel to a patient's teeth

then place them for an hour in front of a light that promotes absorption. Sensitivity may be a problem for a day afterward.

WRINKLE RELEASE: Gets rid of stubborn, deep wrinkles. A needle is used to encircle a wrinkle with a metal thread beneath the skin. When pulled, the thread cuts fibres, pulling the wrinkle down and relaxing it.

PHOTO FACIAL: Intense, pulsed light used to remove brown spots and other sun damage from the face, neck and chest. Shrinks pores and decreases wrinkling.

HYPERBARIC OXYGEN FACIAL: These facials force hyaluronic acid, an ingredient found naturally in the skin and known for its powerful antioxidants, into the skin through a high flow of oxygen.

MICRODERMABRASION: A sandblaster sprays tiny diamond or crystal particles on the face. Messy but gives stars' skin that special polish.



SUBI SAMUEL/ MENSHEALTH